25900114 **Reg No:**

Name :

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

SECOND SEMESTER MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2025
SECOND SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) – MG2DSCHMC100- INTRODUCTION TO HOSPITALITY OPERATIONS-II ROOM DIVITION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration:1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks:50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(AN), Evaluate(E), Create(C)

Skills(S)Interest(I) and Appreciation(AP)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome

to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part-A

Short answer questions

Answer any **10** Questions

Each questions carries 2 marks

1. Why communication between the front office and housekeeping important?

Ans. Communication between the front office and housekeeping is important to ensure rooms are cleaned and ready for guests on time and to fulfil special requests or resolve issues efficiently.

2. What role does problem-solving play in front office Duties?

Ans. Problem-solving in front office duties is essential for handling guest complaints and unexpected issues quickly and professionally to ensure guest satisfaction and smooth hotel operations.

3. Why is the layout of a lobby important for guest experience?

Ans. The layout of a lobby is important for guest experience because it creates a first impression, ensures easy navigation, and provides a comfortable, welcoming space for guests to relax or wait.

4. What is the primary role of housekeeping personnel in a hotel?

Ans. The primary role of housekeeping personnel in a hotel is to maintain cleanliness, order, and overall appearance of guest rooms and public areas to ensure a comfortable and pleasant stay for guests.

5. Name the two key positions in the front office hierarchy.

Ans. The two key positions in the front office hierarchy are the **Front Office Manager** and the **Receptionist**.

6. The difference between a **twin room** and a **double room** is in the bed setup.

Ans.

- A **twin room** has **two separate single beds**, ideal for two people who want to sleep separately.
- A **double room** has **one double bed**, meant for a couple or a single guest who prefers a larger bed.

7.Name one advantage of all-inclusive meal plan for guest.

Ans. One advantage of an all-inclusive meal plan for guests is **cost convenience**, as all meals and drinks are included in the price, helping them budget easily without worrying about extra charges.

8. Define the term presidential suite in luxury hotels.

Ans. A **presidential suite** in luxury hotels is the most prestigious and spacious accommodation, typically offering top-tier amenities, elegant furnishings, multiple rooms, and exclusive services designed for VIPs or high-profile guests.

9. What is a guest registration card(GRC)?

Ans. A **Guest Registration Card (GRC)** is a document filled out by the guest at check-in that records important details like their name, contact information, room number, duration of stay, and signature, serving as a legal record of the guest's registration.

10. What is a standard business room in a hotel?

Ans. A **standard business room** in a hotel is a guest room designed for business travellers, typically offering essentials like a comfortable bed, a work desk, internet access, and basic business amenities for a productive stay.

11. Give two examples each of mechanical and manual housekeeping

equipment.

Ans. **Mechanical housekeeping equipment**: Vacuum cleaner, floor scrubber

Manual housekeeping equipment: Mop, broom

12. Why is it important to clean and maintain manual equipment regularly?

Ans. It is important to clean and maintain manual equipment regularly to ensure it stays effective, lasts longer, and prevents the spread of dirt, germs, or damage during cleaning tasks.

13. Define a squeegee and its use in cleaning.

Ans. A **squeegee** is a cleaning tool with a flat, smooth rubber blade used to remove water or cleaning solution from flat surfaces like windows, mirrors, and floors, leaving them clean and streak-free.

14. What is the difference between detergents and disinfectants?

Ans.

Detergents are cleaning agents used to remove dirt, grease, and stains from surfaces.

Disinfectants are chemicals used to kill germs, bacteria, and viruses on surfaces.

15. What is a polishing machine, and why is it used?

Ans. A **polishing machine** is a mechanical device used to buff and shine floors, making them smooth, glossy, and attractive. It is used to enhance the appearance of floors and protect them from wear and tear.

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any 4 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

16. Describe five key duties of front office personnel.

Ans.

Guest Check-in and Check-out: Handle the arrival and departure procedures smoothly, including registration and billing.

Reservation Management: Manage bookings, cancellations, and room assignments accurately.

Handling Guest Requests and Complaints: Assist guests with their needs and resolve any issues professionally.

Providing Information: Offer guests information about hotel facilities, local attractions, and services.

Maintaining Records: Keep accurate records of guest stays, payments, and correspondence for smooth operations.

17. What impact did railways and automobiles have on the hotel industry?

Ans.

Increased Travel: Railways and automobiles made travel more accessible and affordable, expanding the guest pool for hotels.

Boosted Regional Tourism: With better transportation options, tourists could easily reach different regions, increasing demand for hotels in both urban and rural areas.

Growth of Hotel Chains: The rise in travel led to the expansion of hotel chains, creating standardized lodging options for travellers.

Longer Stays: Travelers could now reach destinations faster, leading to longer stays and more bookings at hotels.

New Market Segments: Railways and automobiles created opportunities for hotels to cater to different market segments, such as road trippers, business travellers, and tourists.

18. Discuss the importance of meal plan flexibility in hotel reservations.

Ans.

Guest Satisfaction: Flexible meal plans allow guests to choose the option that best suits their needs, increasing satisfaction and enhancing their overall experience.

Increased Bookings: Offering various meal plans (e.g., breakfast-only, half-board, full-board, all-inclusive) attracts a wider range of guests with different preferences, leading to more bookings.

Cost Control for Guests: Flexible meal plans help guests manage their budgets by selecting meal options that align with their travel preferences and expenses.

Improved Hotel Revenue: Hotels can generate additional revenue by offering different meal plan choices, particularly through upgraded plans like all-inclusive.

Catering to Business and Leisure Travelers: Flexibility allows hotels to cater to both business travellers (who may prefer fewer meals) and leisure guests (who may opt for more comprehensive meal plans).

19. List and explain five sources of reservations for hotels.

Ans.

Online Travel Agencies (OTAs): Websites like Booking.com, Expedia, and Airbnb allow guests to book rooms through third-party platforms, helping hotels reach a wider audience.

Hotel Website: Guests can make direct reservations through the hotel's own website, which can offer special deals or discounts to encourage direct bookings and reduce commission fees to third parties.

Global Distribution Systems (GDS): Platforms like Amadeus, Sabre, and Galileo are used by travel agents and corporate clients to book hotel rooms, making them a significant source of business, particularly for international travel.

Travel Agents: Traditional and online travel agencies still play an important role in hotel bookings, especially for package deals or group bookings.

Walk-ins: Guests who arrive at the hotel without prior reservations can book a room on the spot, typically depending on availability, especially during off-peak times.

20. Describe the role of disinfectants in housekeeping and how they are selected.

Ans.

Role in Maintaining Hygiene: Disinfectants are essential in housekeeping to kill harmful bacteria, viruses, and germs on surfaces, ensuring a clean and sanitary environment for guests and staff.

Preventing Cross-contamination: Disinfectants help prevent the spread of infectious diseases, particularly in high-touch areas like door handles, switches, and bathrooms.

Ensuring Guest Safety: Proper use of disinfectants protects guests from exposure to harmful pathogens, contributing to a healthier stay.

Choosing Based on Surface Type: Disinfectants are selected based on the surface they'll be used on (e.g., wood, tiles, or glass) to avoid damage while ensuring effective cleaning.

Choosing Based on Effectiveness: The effectiveness of disinfectants depends on their chemical composition. Hotels select those that meet industry standards for killing bacteria and viruses, often considering factors like EPA approval and the type of microorganism being targeted.

21. What are the common mechanical failures in housekeeping equipment and how are they fixed?

Ans. Here's a breakdown of common mechanical failures in housekeeping equipment and how they are fixed:

1. **Vacuum Cleaner**

   Common Failure: Loss of suction or clogged hoses.

   Fix: Clean the filter, check and clear the hose for blockages, and ensure the vacuum bag is not full.

2. **Floor Scrubber**

   Common Failure: The machine stops working or loses power.

   Fix: Check the battery or power connection, ensure brushes are attached properly, and clean the scrubber deck to remove debris.

3. **Polishing Machine**

   Common Failure: The machine's motor overheats or malfunctions.

   Fix: Turn off and allow it to cool down; check for loose connections or damaged parts, and ensure regular maintenance is done to prevent wear.

4. **Laundry Machines**

   Common Failure: Failure to start or excessive noise during operation.

   Fix: Check the power source, inspect for any blockages or worn-out components, and clean the drum and filters regularly.

5. **Steam Cleaners**

   Common Failure: Low or no steam output.

Fix: Ensure the water tank is filled, check for clogged steam nozzles, and clean or replace filters as needed.

Part C

Short Essay Questions

Answer any 1 question

Each question carries 10 mark

22. Compare and contrast the layouts of a housekeeping department in a small hotel and a luxury hotel

Ans. 1. Size and Space Allocation

Small Hotel: In a small hotel, the housekeeping department tends to be more compact, with limited space for storage, laundry, and equipment. Often, multiple functions are combined into one area, such as combining linen storage with cleaning supply storage. The space is efficiently used but might feel cramped.

Luxury Hotel: A luxury hotel has a much larger housekeeping department with dedicated areas for specific functions, such as separate storage rooms for clean linens, dirty linens, and cleaning supplies. The space is more spacious and organized, with designated staff areas and rooms for equipment, allowing for smooth operations without overcrowding.

2. Staff Facilities

Small Hotel: Staff facilities in a small hotel may be minimal. The department might share spaces such as break rooms or locker rooms, and often, there's not much room for rest or recreation. Due to the smaller staff size, employees may need to multitask or handle more than one responsibility.

Luxury Hotel: Luxury hotels provide larger, more comfortable staff facilities, including spacious break rooms, lockers, restrooms, and even areas for staff relaxation. There is often a higher staff-to-guest ratio in luxury hotels, and the department structure supports a more focused and organized workload. Staff may also have access to professional development areas or a dedicated supervisor's office.

3. Linen and Storage Management

Small Hotel: Linen storage in small hotels is typically compact, and they may lack space for large-scale storage. There is often a limited variety of linens, and inventory management may be less advanced, requiring frequent restocking. Linen is stored in a small room or closet, and items may need to be reordered more frequently.

Luxury Hotel: In luxury hotels, linen storage is highly organized and expansive, with a separate area for clean linens and one for dirty ones. The linen room is larger to accommodate high volumes of inventory, including specialty items like bathrobes, luxury towels, and specialty bed linens. The inventory is well-managed, often tracked using technology to ensure there is always an adequate supply of linens.

4. Laundry Operations

Small Hotel: Laundry services in small hotels may be limited and often done in-house using standard, compact machines. The laundry area is smaller, and laundry might need to be outsourced during peak times. The hotel may not offer high-end services such as dry cleaning or specialized laundry.

Luxury Hotel: Luxury hotels feature a dedicated, large-scale laundry room with commercial-grade washers and dryers to handle high volumes of laundry. They also often have specialized laundry services like dry cleaning, pressing, and stain removal. The staff uses high-quality, well-maintained equipment to ensure that laundry is completed efficiently and to a high standard.

5. Technology and Equipment

Small Hotel: Small hotels may have limited technology, relying on manual systems for scheduling room cleaning, inventory management, and guest requests. Equipment is typically standard, with a focus on essential items like vacuums, mops, and cleaning carts. Advanced tracking systems may be absent.

Luxury Hotel: Luxury hotels often invest in advanced housekeeping technology, including room management systems (to track which rooms are cleaned), inventory management systems (to track linen and supplies), and mobile devices that allow staff to communicate in real-time. Equipment is state-of-the-art, including high-end vacuum cleaners, floor scrubbers, and industrial laundry machines. Technology improves efficiency and helps maintain high standards of cleanliness.

6. Room Assignments and Staff Workflow

Small Hotel: Housekeeping staff in small hotels usually manage all cleaning and maintenance duties on a single floor or a smaller section of the property. The workflow is relatively simple, and staff may be responsible for both cleaning guest rooms and attending to public areas, leading to a more generalized approach.

Luxury Hotel: In luxury hotels, the housekeeping department is more complex, with staff divided into specialized roles. Some staff may handle guest rooms, while others focus on public areas, laundry, or deep cleaning. Staff work in teams to ensure that rooms are cleaned to a high standard, and there is often a floor supervisor to oversee daily operations. The workflow is more structured and organized.

7. Cleaning and Maintenance

Small Hotel: In smaller hotels, housekeeping staff may be responsible for all aspects of cleaning, including guest rooms, public areas, and back-of-house areas. The maintenance of cleaning equipment may be simpler, with minor repairs handled by in-house staff or outsourced when necessary.

Luxury Hotel: Luxury hotels typically have specialized cleaning teams for different areas. For example, guest room cleaning is handled by one group, while public area cleaning may be handled by another. Maintenance for housekeeping equipment is usually outsourced to professionals or handled by a dedicated in-house team, ensuring high-quality equipment maintenance.

8. Space for Housekeeping Equipment

Small Hotel: Storage for housekeeping equipment in small hotels tends to be limited, and cleaning tools may be stored in a small closet or shared spaces. There is often a lack of designated areas for equipment, meaning the staff may have to work with limited resources.

Luxury Hotel: A luxury hotel has dedicated rooms or closets for storing housekeeping equipment, ensuring everything is organized and easily accessible. The equipment room is spacious, with enough storage for various cleaning tools, chemicals, and safety equipment, making the housekeeping staff's job more efficient.

9. Guest Interaction

Small Hotel: Housekeeping staff in small hotels may have more direct interaction with guests, especially if they perform multiple roles, such as room cleaning and guest service. The smaller environment allows staff to have a more personal connection with guests.

Luxury Hotel: In luxury hotels, housekeeping staff generally have less direct contact with guests, as the services are more specialized. However, they still ensure that rooms are prepared according to guest preferences and attend to requests through the front desk or concierge. The focus is on maintaining a high standard of service without direct guest interaction.

10. Cost Efficiency and Budget

Small Hotel: Small hotels generally operate on tighter budgets with fewer resources. This impacts the layout of the housekeeping department, which may be more compact, and equipment that is essential but not always the latest or most advanced.

Luxury Hotel: Luxury hotels have larger budgets and are willing to invest in top-tier equipment, advanced technology, and spacious housekeeping departments. This allows for higher-quality service, better organization, and more efficient operations.

23. Describe the training and development programs necessary for housekeeping employees

1. Orientation Training

Purpose: To introduce new employees to the hotel's policies, procedures, standards, and culture.

Details: Covers hotel layout, safety policies, dress codes, housekeeping duties, and expectations regarding guest service.

2. Skill-based Training

Purpose: To ensure employees know the correct techniques for cleaning, bed-making, handling laundry, and using housekeeping equipment.

Details: Practical demonstrations on how to clean different surfaces, operate machines like vacuum cleaners and polishers, and proper chemical usage.

3. Safety and Health Training

Purpose: To protect employees and guests by promoting safe work practices.

Details: Includes training on chemical handling (MSDS sheets), lifting techniques, fire safety procedures, and personal protective equipment (PPE) usage.

4. Customer Service Training

Purpose: To equip housekeeping staff with skills to interact professionally and politely with guests.

Details: Focuses on communication skills, handling guest requests or complaints, body language, and maintaining guest privacy and confidentiality.

5. Supervisory and Leadership Training

Purpose: To prepare experienced housekeeping staff for supervisory roles.

Details: Teaches skills such as team management, scheduling, quality inspections, inventory control, and conflict resolution.

6. Technical and Equipment Training

Purpose: To ensure staff can operate modern housekeeping equipment efficiently and safely.

Details: Covers the correct usage, maintenance, and troubleshooting of machines like floor scrubbers, steam cleaners, and commercial laundry machines.

7. Environmental Awareness Training

Purpose: To promote sustainable housekeeping practices.

Details: Teaches staff how to minimize waste, conserve energy, recycle, and use eco-friendly products in line with hotel environmental policies.

8. Quality Control Training

Purpose: To ensure consistent delivery of high service standards.

Details: Covers checklists for room cleaning, how to inspect work, maintain standards for VIP rooms, and spot common cleaning mistakes.

9. Cross-training

Purpose: To build a flexible workforce that can handle multiple tasks.

Details: Staff learn additional roles like public area cleaning, laundry operations, or room attendant duties to support different areas during peak times.

10. Ongoing Refresher Courses and Development Programs

Purpose: To keep staff updated with new cleaning technologies, products, and guest expectations.

Details: Regular workshops, seminars, and e-learning programs to enhance skills and introduce innovations in housekeeping practices.

24. Discuss the impact of professional bell desk services on overall guest experience.

1. Ans. First and Last Impressions

The bell desk staff are often the first to greet guests upon arrival and the last to assist them at departure. A professional, welcoming, and efficient service creates a strong positive impression, setting the tone for the guest's entire stay.

2. Efficient Handling of Luggage

Professional bell desk services ensure that luggage is handled carefully and delivered promptly to guest rooms. This attention to detail provides convenience and comfort, making the arrival and departure process smooth and stress-free.

3. Personalized Assistance

Bell desk staff often offer personalized help such as escorting guests to their rooms, explaining room features, and offering tips about hotel facilities. This personal touch makes guests feel valued and cared for.

4. Additional Services

Professional bell desk teams handle services like arranging transportation, managing luggage storage, and providing local area information. This adds to guest convenience and enhances the hotel's reputation for outstanding service.

5. Problem Resolution

Bell desk staff can quickly assist with unexpected issues, such as lost luggage or urgent transportation needs. Their quick and polite responses improve guest satisfaction and build trust in the hotel's overall service.

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